

ing in “Digit-February 2002-Insight-Quick Start-30 Minutes Expert” you will be better off by giving this a shorter value such as “DigFeb02-IN-QS-30”. Not only will the search be faster but also be better indexed which will let retrieve data faster.

Now imagine the same thing being done with over a billion files on a network. There is bound to be confusion and ultimately chaos. Therefore, what happened was each file that was uploaded to the edonkey network was hashed uniquely and checked and then made available.

This made downloads simple, quicker and reliable. But the same problems that affected the Kazaa network, which were spyware, viruses and Trojans, also affected the eDonkey network. To overcome this, the community came out with Web sites that listed verified content that was being made available on the eDonkey2000 network. Since all of these downloads were verified and checked, there was a large reduction in the number of fake applications and the network survived.

Once again, though, the RIAA (Recording Industry Association of America) and MPAA (Motion Picture Association of America) swung into action and started proceedings for legal action against several network communities and the process still goes on. With all of this going on, something was coming and it promised to revolutionise P2P. BitTorrent suddenly crept in on P2P users and proved to be the saviour for those who feared that the best was already over.